

ENERGY

Energy is a resource, not a virtue.

How to hold a steady pace without burning out mid year.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

And a resource gets managed, restored and spent with criteria.

THE CASCADE

How you arrive broken in July.



WHAT YOU SEE

You start the year at maximum pace...



THE MECHANISM

...maximum pace becomes the new expected normal...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and by mid year there is no reserve for what matters.

When every day is a push day, you do not have intensity, you have no plan.

THE FORK

Three signs of the wrong beat.

THREE SIGNS

01

Simple decisions got hard? The reserve is running out.

02

Effort went up and the result did not? The pace is off.

03

You stopped proposing new things? Energy is in maintenance.

Exhaustion gives no advance notice. Those three signs do.

THE METHOD

The four beats of pace.

01 **PUSH**

concentrated effort, with a start date and an end date

02 **SUSTAIN**

steady, predictable pace, where most of the year is spent

03 **RECOVER**

scheduled on purpose, not what is left over after the push

04 **REVIEW**

what comes off the list so the next cycle actually fits

Pushing with no recovery is not grit, it is an advance you repay with interest.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Four choices about pace.

01 • PUSH

A push with an end date.

extra effort with no defined end becomes a permanent schedule

02 • SUSTAIN

Recovery on the calendar.

the week after the push comes in lighter, and that is planned

03 • RECOVER

Cut before you add.

for every new thing that enters, something leaves the list

04 • REVIEW

Agree the pace with the team.

a pace only you know becomes pressure nobody understands

TWO MODELS

Intensity with no plan or pace with a plan.

THE COMMON MODEL

No plan

Every day at maximum pace

Recovery is whatever is left

The list only grows

Delivers a lot until it stops delivering

THE DESIGNED MODEL

With a plan

Pushes when it makes a difference

Recovers on purpose

Cuts with every new entry

Delivers all year long

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three drains nobody counts.

01 Deciding the same thing several times.

- a repeated decision costs more energy than a hard one.
-

02 Carrying an unresolved conflict for months.

- what you avoid discussing occupies mental space every day.
-

03 Working with no visible effect from the effort.

- effort with no visible result drains faster than volume does.
-

Energy rarely runs out from volume. It runs out from no meaning and no closure.

THE CHAIN

The Friday test.

01

It is Friday afternoon and someone brings a simple decision.



02

Do you push it to Monday, every week?



03

The problem was not the week, it was the pace you chose.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

An energy reserve is measured on Friday, not on Monday morning.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

How to reset the pace this week.



STEP 01

Give an end date to the push currently running.

and communicate that date, it relieves the team on its own



STEP 02

Take one thing off the list before accepting the next.

with no cut, every new pace is a pace stacked on the old one



STEP 03

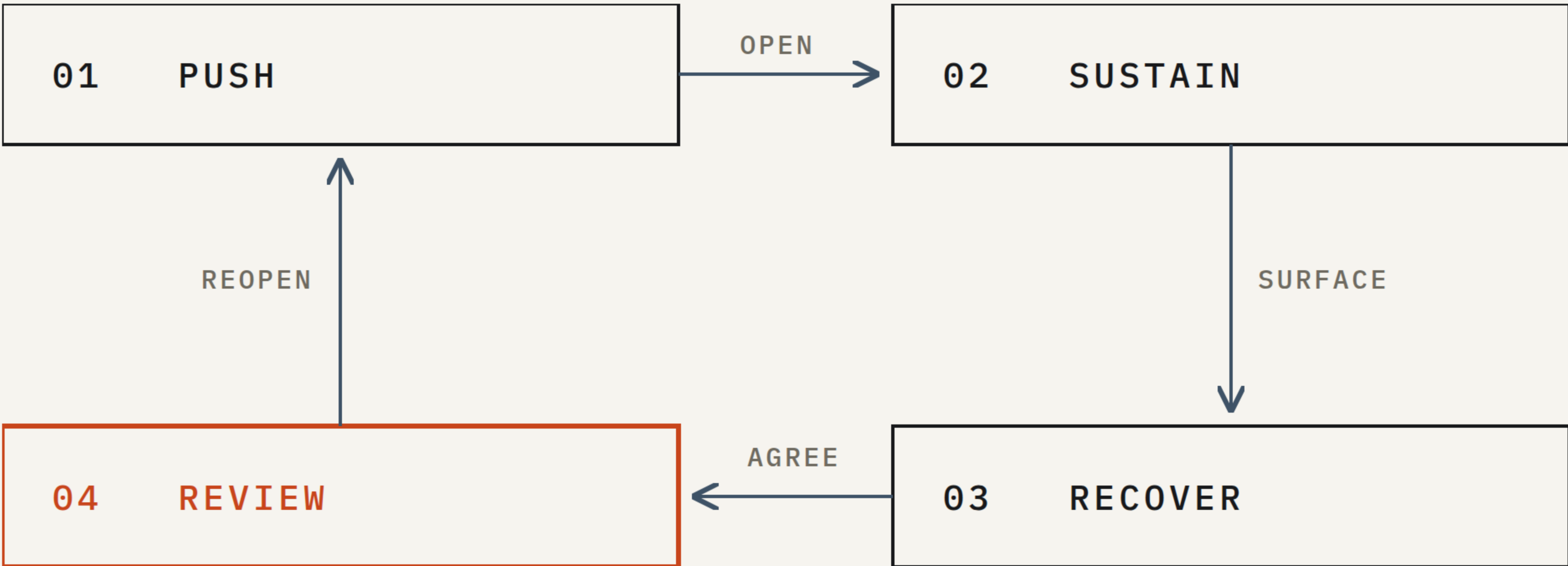
Schedule a lighter week after the delivery.

planned recovery is what makes the next push possible

Consistency is not a frantic pace, it is a pace you can repeat.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Four Beats, a loop and not a list.



Burning out mid year is not a sign of effort.
It is a sign of a badly chosen pace.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

next time you accept one more push.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA